

| Assessment | Test | Domain        | Skill               | Difficulty                                          |
|------------|------|---------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| SAT        | Math | Advanced Math | Nonlinear functions | Medium <div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |

Question

An object is kicked from a platform. The equation  $h = -4.9t^2 + 7t + 9$  represents this situation, where  $h$  is the height of the object above the ground, in meters,  $t$  seconds after it is kicked. Which number represents the height, in meters, from which the object was kicked?

Answer

- A. 0
- B. 4.9
- C. 7
- D. 9

Correct Answer: D

Rationale

Choice D is correct. It’s given that the equation  $h = -4.9t^2 + 7t + 9$  represents this situation, where  $h$  is the height, in meters, of the object  $t$  seconds after it is kicked. It follows that the height, in meters, from which the object was kicked is the value of  $h$  when  $t = 0$ . Substituting 0 for  $t$  in the equation  $h = -4.9t^2 + 7t + 9$  yields  $h = -4.9(0)^2 + 7(0) + 9$ , or  $h = 9$ . Therefore, the object was kicked from a height of 9 meters.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.